

DIAN LUO

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EMPLOYMENT

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Postdoc Research Associate

Mentor: Timothy Tansey, and Malachy Bishop

Sep 2025-Present

EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

PhD in Population Health (Minor in Statistics)

Sep 2020-Aug 2025

Dissertation: Health Care Equity of Post-acute Care in Inpatient Rehabilitation Facilities: Comparison Between Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage

Committee members: Ying (Jessica) Cao (Chair), Mariétou Ouayogodé, John Mullahy, Marguerite Burns, and Wan-chin Kuo

Emory University

MPH in Health Policy and Management

Aug 2018-May 2020

Southwest University

BA in Economics

Sep 2014-Jun 2018

PUBLICATION

Kuo, W.-c., **Luo, D.**, Brown, R. L., Hruska, C., & Wang, C.-J. (2025). Where we work correlates with whether we receive cardiorespiratory preventive care services: Health and Retirement Study 2003–2018. *BMC Public Health*, 26(1), 69. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12889-025-24748-z>

Luo, D., Cao, Y., Ouayogodé, M. H., Kuo, W.-c., Mullahy, J., & Burns, M. E. (2025). Length of stay of post-acute care: determinants and differences between traditional medicare and medicare advantage. *Health Affairs Scholar*, 3(11), qxaf195. <https://doi.org/10.1093/haschl/qxaf195>

Luo, D., Kuo, Wc (2024). Great leap forward famine exposure and urban-rural migration convolute the modern prevalence of diabetes in China. *J Health Popul Nutr* 43, 109. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41043-024-00596-2>.

Luo, D., Ouayogode, M. H., Mullahy, J., & Cao, Y. J. (2024). Regional variation in length of stay for stroke inpatient rehabilitation in traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage. *Health Aff Sch*, 2(7), qxae089. <https://doi.org/10.1093/haschl/qxae089>

Cao, Y. J., & **Luo, D.** (2023). Post-Acute Care in Inpatient Rehabilitation Facilities Between Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage Plans Before and During the COVID-19 Pandemic. *J Am Med Dir Assoc*, 24(6), 868-875 e865. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jamda.2023.03.030>

Green, T. L., Vu, H., Swan, L. E. T., **Luo, D.**, Hickman, E., Plaisime, M., & Hagiwara, N. (2023). Implicit and explicit racial prejudice among medical professionals: updated estimates from a population-based study. *The Lancet Regional Health – Americas*, 21. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.lana.2023.100489>

Luo, D. (2022). Regional variation in healthcare usage for Medicare beneficiaries: a cross-sectional study based on the health and retirement study. *BMJ open*, 12(8), e061375. <https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2022-061375>

Luo, D., Deng, J., & Becker, E. R. (2021). Urban-rural differences in healthcare utilization among beneficiaries in China's new cooperative medical scheme. *BMC Public Health*, 21(1), 1519. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12889-021-11573-3>

Leng, Y., **Luo, D.**, Liu, L., Ma, Y., & Deng, J. (2021). Research on the economic risk of diseases in middle-aged and elderly patients with diabetes—evidence from China. *Journal of Public Health*, 29(5), 1001-1011. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10389-020-01208-z>

PRESENTATION

Invited Presentation

Health Care Equity of Post-acute Care in Inpatient Rehabilitation Facilities: Comparison Between Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage. Weil Cornell Medical College. New York City, NY, Feb 6, 2025.

Podium Presentation

The Effect of Repealing Section 14(c) on Employment Outcomes Among People with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities: Evidence from RSA-911 (2017-2024). Academy Health, Annual Research Meeting (ARM), Seattle, May 30, 2026.

The Effect of Repealing Section 14(c) on Employment Outcomes Among People with Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities: Evidence from RSA-911 (2017-2024). National Association of Rehabilitation Research and Training Centers (NARRTC) Conference and Business Meeting. Alexandria, VA, April 14, 2026.

Poster Presentation

Adaptation of the AHA Heart Health Promotion Model for Black Americans with Among the Highest Community Rates of Hypertension Morbidity and Mortality. American Heart Association's (AHA) Hypertension Scientific Sessions. Baltimore, MD, October 16, 2025.

Where We Work Correlates with Whether We Receive Cardiorespiratory Preventive Care Services. American Heart Association (AHA) Scientific Sessions. Chicago, IL, November 11, 2024.

Regional Variation of Length of Stay for Inpatient Rehabilitation Services Among Stroke Patients Before and During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Comparison Between US Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting (ARM). Seattle, WA. June 26, 2023.

Conference Panels Organized

Maternal Health Equity in Medicaid: Coverage, Incentives, and Outcomes. Academy Health Annual Research (ARM) Meeting. Seattle, WA, June 2, 2026.

Discussant

Maternal Health Equity in Medicaid: Coverage, Incentives, and Outcomes. Academy Health Annual Research (ARM) Meeting. Seattle, WA, June 2, 2026.

REFEREE EXPERIENCE

Archives of Public Health, BMC Health Services Research, BMC Public Health, BMC Geriatrics, Cost Effectiveness and Resource Allocation, Health Affairs Scholar, Health Services Research, International Journal for Equity in Health.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Wisconsin-Madison, School of Nursing, Madison, WI

Dec 2024-May 2025

Project Assistant of Dr. Linda Oakley

Project: Linking stress co-occurrence and mind-body proliferation to hypertension in Black communities: The role of mind-body awareness

- Conducted literature review on the association between environmental stress and hypertension among black people.
- Extracted data and performed latent profile analysis and regression analysis in STATA&R to examine the stress co-occurrence phenomenon and its associations with systolic blood pressure.
- Summarized results and prepared the manuscript. We found that Frequent stress co-occurrence and mind-body proliferation are associated with systolic blood pressure in black communities.

University of Wisconsin-Madison, UW-Madison School of Medicine and Public Health, Madison, WI

Jan 2022-Nov 2024

Department of Population Health Sciences

Project Assistant of Dr. Ying Cao

Project I: Comparison of Post-Acute Care in Inpatient Rehabilitation Facilities between Beneficiaries with Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage Plans: 2019-2020

- Conducted literature review on comparison between Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage plans related to health outcomes in the inpatient rehabilitation facilities.
- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in STATA&R to trace the change of length of stay (LOS), payment, and place of discharges before and during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Summarized results and prepared the manuscript. We found that Medicare beneficiaries had longer LOS, lower payment per episode, more discharges to home with HHA, and less to SNF than TM beneficiaries. During the pandemic, both plan types had shorter LOS, higher payment, increased discharges to home with HHA, and decreased discharges to SNF compared to that before the COVID-19 pandemic.

Project II: Regional Variation of Length of Stay for Inpatient Rehabilitation Services Among Stroke Patients: Comparison between US Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage

- Conducted literature review on comparison between Traditional Medicare and Medicare Advantage plans related to health outcomes in the inpatient rehabilitation facilities.

- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in STATA&R to trace the regional variation change of length of stay (LOS) among stroke patients before and during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Summarized results and prepared the manuscript. We found that risk-adjusted average LOS decreased for both TM and MA during the pandemic, whereas the regional variation decreased among TM-covered episodes but increased among MA-covered ones. The changes were driven by a few different regions between TM and MA.

University of Wisconsin-Madison, UW-Madison School of Medicine and Public Health, Madison, WI

Sep 2020-Aug 2021

Department of Population Health Sciences

Project Assistant of Dr. Marietou Ouayogode

Project I: COVID-19 and Employment Security: The Case of Wisconsin

- Conducted literature review on the association between COVID-19 and employment security.
- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in STATA&R to trace the change of 1) employment rate 2) unemployment rate 3) the number of labor force 4) wage between 2010 and 2021 based on U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics.
- Prepared the abstract to describe these changes and found most states had the lowest employment rate in March 2020 and quickly recovered later.

Project II: COVID-19, Food Security, and Obesity in Wisconsin

- Conducted literature review on the association between COVID-19 and food security and the association between COVID-19 and obesity.
- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in STATA&R to compare the pre and post COVID-19 pandemic difference in food security and the relationship between food security and obesity based on the Survey of the Health of Wisconsin.
- Prepared the abstract to summarize results and found that food insecurity was highly associated with overweight and was more prevalent in post COVID-19 pandemic.

Project III: COVID-19-related Discrimination, Stress related Racism, and Discrimination in Wisconsin

- Conducted literature review on the association between COVID-19 and discrimination.
- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in STATA&R to compare the pre and post COVID-19 pandemic difference in discrimination based on the Survey of the Health of Wisconsin.
- Prepared the abstract and found that race discrimination was more likely to happen on minor groups, especially on Asians, in post COVID-19 pandemic.

University of Wisconsin-Madison, UW-Madison School of Medicine and Public Health, Madison, WI

Sept 2020-Dec 2021

Department of Population Health Sciences

Project Assistant of Dr. Tiffany Green

Project I: Data Analysis for Project Implicit Data

- Cooperated with colleagues to create data dictionary for race-based and weight bias project implicit data.
- Collaborated with colleagues to conduct preliminary data cleaning and created STATA datasets for project implicit data.
- Cleaned the Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS) data and created STATA datasets for BRFSS data.
- Integrated BRFSS data into project implicit data and created descriptive tables.

Project II: Implicit and Explicit Racial Prejudice among Medical Professionals: Updated Estimates

- Conducted literature review on implicit and explicit anti-Black prejudice among US physicians.
- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in STATA to assess the associations between self-reported occupational status (physician, non-physician healthcare worker) and implicit and explicit prejudice toward Black, Arab-Muslim, Asian, and Native Americans, net of demographic characteristics.
- Summarized results and prepared the manuscript. We found that physicians and non-physician healthcare workers exhibited more implicit and explicit anti-Black and anti-Arab-Muslim prejudice than the general population.

Emory University, Rollins School of Public Health, Atlanta, GA

Feb 2019-Aug 2021

Department of Health Policy and Management

Graduate Research Assistant of Dr. Edmund Becker

Project I: Urban-rural Differences in Healthcare Utilization Among Rural Hukou Beneficiaries of the New Cooperative Medical Scheme in China

- Explored the association between healthcare utilization and living area among the Chinese beneficiaries of the New Cooperative Medical Scheme.
- Conducted multilevel regressions to test the association using Stata based on the data from the Chinese Health and Retirement Longitudinal Study in 2015.

- Drafted manuscript for publication and found that rural residents have higher frequency and probability on both inpatient and outpatient visits than urban beneficiaries.

Project II: Urban-rural Differences in the Distribution and Risk Factors of Diabetes Among Rural Hukou Beneficiaries of New Cooperative Medical Scheme in China

- Conducted literature review on the association between obesity and diabetes among the Chinese middle-aged and elderly population in urban vs. rural areas
- Extracted data and performed preliminary analysis in Stata to compare urban-rural differences of prevalence, risk, and association of diabetes and obesity based on the Chinese Health and Retirement Longitudinal Study in 2011, 2013, and 2015
- Prepared the manuscript for publication and found the obesity or overweight rural and urban residents are more likely to have diabetes, while the association is stronger among rural residents

Columbia University, Mailman School of Public Health, New York City, NY

May 2019-Dec 2020

Department of Epidemiology

Graduate Research Assistant of Dr. L. H. Lumey

Project I: The Economic Burden of Disease in Middle-Aged and Elderly People with Diabetes

- Collaborated with colleagues to conduct literature review on the economic burden of diabetics among middle-aged and elderly Chinese.
- Compared differences of medical expenditure between aware and unaware diabetics using Stata.
- Drafted manuscript for submission and found that unaware diabetics have higher medical expenditures and a larger healthcare expenditure increasing rate than aware diabetics in both 2011 and 2015.

Project II: Urban and Rural Disparities in Healthcare Expenditures Among Rural Hukou Beneficiaries of New Cooperative Medical Scheme in China

- Investigated the history and policies changes of Chinese Social Health Insurance since 1949, especially the changes after the healthcare reform in 2009.
- Performed multilevel analysis in Stata to compare urban-rural differences of medical expenditures among rural beneficiaries of Chinese Social Health Insurance.
- Prepared the manuscript for publication and found that rural beneficiaries have higher outpatient expenditures but less inpatient expenditures than urban residents.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical software: R; Stata; SAS; Python.

Language: Chinese (native) and English (professional fluency).

REFERENCES

Timothy Tansey, Ph.D.
Professor
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University of Wisconsin-Madison
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(Jessica) Ying Cao, Ph.D.
Assistant Professor
Department of Population Health Sciences
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Malachy Bishop, Ph.D.
Norman L. and Barbara M. Berven Professor of Rehabilitation Psychology
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